

# Paper Craft Reading Template

*Read papers for craft, not just content. Fill this out for one great paper per week.*

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## PAPER

|               |  |
|---------------|--|
| Title:        |  |
| Authors:      |  |
| Venue / Year: |  |

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## A BEFORE READING PAST THE ABSTRACT

*Read only the title and abstract. Fill these in from your own reasoning. The goal is to practice predicting what good science looks like.*

### What's the claim?

*In one sentence — what are they arguing?*

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### What's the surprise?

*What prior belief does this challenge? Who would update?*

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### What would I do to test this?

*Before seeing their method — what experiments would you design? What controls would you run?*

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### Killer alternative explanation

*What's the easiest way to dismiss this without accepting the claim?*

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## B AFTER READING THE FULL PAPER

### What did they do that I didn't predict?

*Controls you missed? Experimental choices that surprised you? Framing moves you wouldn't have made?*

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### The structural moves

*How does the introduction set up tension? How do the studies build on each other? What's the one sentence in the intro doing the heavy lifting?*

### How do they foreclose alternative explanations?

*Map each major alternative to the specific experiment/control that blocks it.*

### Depth level of the paper

| Level | Description                                      | ✓ |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------|---|
| 0     | Proposes X, it works                             |   |
| 1     | X works + strong evidence                        |   |
| 2     | Why X works + reveals problem structure          |   |
| 3     | General principle that reframes broader thinking |   |

## C WHAT I LEARNED ABOUT CRAFT

### The framing lesson

*How did they frame a potentially boring finding as important? What's the broadest truthful audience they're reaching?*

### Fruitfulness

*What new questions does this paper open? Is it a dead-end corridor or a crossroads?*

### Could my lab have done this?

*If yes — what stopped us? If no — what resources/skills are we missing?*

### One thing I'll steal

*One specific technique, structural move, or framing trick to apply to my own work.*

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*Lossfunk Research · One paper per week · After 20 papers, review your 'one thing I'll steal' list for patterns*